

Repeat listening is growth's hidden ceiling at Spotify

- 629 public feedback posts analyzed | 100% themed
- Growth PM case: increase meaningful discovery, reduce comfort loops
- Music Discovery Graduation Project | NextLeap

Millions of users still listen from comfort playlists, not discovery

- Spotify has world-class recommendations - yet repeat playlists dominate listening
- Strategic goal: meaningful music discovery at scale
- Hypothesis: friction is behavioral (when to choose), not only algorithm quality

We analyzed 629 public feedback posts across 4 channels

- Google Play (87%) | Reddit | Community forums | Social media
- Pipeline: Collect -> Normalize -> AI theme classify -> Insights dashboard
- Review Discovery Engine: <https://graduation-project-pm-m4tixl62qusc7yxqkc8sux.streamlit.app>

Users repeat because decision fatigue beats risky exploration

- 1. Hard to find new music: 48.6% (306 posts)
- 2. Free tier limits exploration: 33.2% (209 posts)
- 3. Same content on loop: 4.8% (30 posts)

Quote: "After office I only open my 2022 indie playlist - new music feels like work."

Interviews confirmed AI themes - and revealed one surprise

- n=6 segment-fit interviews (Indian urban 22-35, playlist-heavy listeners)
- Validated: discovery friction, repeat listening, library clutter (Y)
- Surprise: looping peaks at transition moments (commute home) - not bad algo alone
- Users want: short explanation + 3 options, not another feed

The real problem: transition-moment decision fatigue

- Segment defaults to 2-3 comfort playlists when mental energy is low
- Root cause: decision fatigue > recommendation quality at end-of-day moments
- JTBD: low-effort break from loop without endless Home scroll
- Not the problem: 'algorithm is always wrong'

Traditional recommendation optimizes familiarity, not intentional discovery

- Collaborative filtering reinforces taste clusters -> comfort loops
- Discover Weekly is batch + black-box -> skipped when mood uncertain
- Business metrics: discovery session rate | new artist listens | D7 retention
- Gap: no explainable coach at the moment users choose autopilot

LoopBreak explains why you're stuck - then offers 3 discovery paths

- AI-native MVP: diagnosis + 3 strategies (mood / social / forgotten saves)
- Grounded in 629-post corpus + interview synthesis (Groq + research prompts)
- Production MVP: <https://graduation-project-pm-dinw6d4yfwhbksv6ffew6u.streamlit.app>
- No Spotify API v1 - prototypes interaction + explainability (v2: catalog)

AI changes UX from passive feed to guided discovery with agency

- Before: open app -> same playlist -> passive play
- After: describe moment -> why looping -> pick a path -> intentional action
- AI unlocks: intent, moment context, reasoning aloud, strategy not just tracks

Success metrics: discovery sessions, new artists, D7 retention

- Primary: discovery session rate (% sessions with play outside top 3 playlists)
- Secondary: new artist listen rate | loop-break rate at transition moments
- Next experiment: A/B coach at 6pm vs control Home for segment
- Thank you | Workflow + MVP links on prior slides